

ZEILAN PARADISE

SAMPLE ITINERARY · SIGNATURE

Classic Ceylon & Coast

The complete first visit at an easy pace: three nights among the ancient cities, sacred Kandy, two nights in tea country, the mountain village of Ella and three days on a palm-fringed beach to finish.

LENGTH	BEST TIME	IDEAL FOR	STYLE
14 Days / 13 Nights	December – April	First-time couples	Private & tailor-made

Every itinerary is a starting point: we tailor the route, hotels and pace to each client.

ZEILAN SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE

Village cycling and a home-cooked lunch with a farming family near Sigiriya

Highlights

- Village cycling and a home-cooked lunch with a farming family near Sigiriya
- Cycling the medieval royal city of Polonnaruwa
- A dawn walk to World's End in Horton Plains National Park
- Little Adam's Peak and the Nine Arches Bridge in Ella
- Optional whale watching from Mirissa with a responsible operator

Where you stay

Negombo 1 night · Sigiriya 3 nights · Kandy 2 nights · Nuwara Eliya 2 nights · Ella 2 nights · Mirissa 3 nights

Hotels are chosen with you when we plan the journey.

Day by day

1 **Welcome to Sri Lanka** NEGOMBO

Your chauffeur-guide meets you at the airport and takes you to your hotel in Negombo, 20 minutes away. Rest after the flight and enjoy a sunset dinner by the sea.

2 **Into the Cultural Triangle** SIGIRIYA

Drive north through villages and paddy fields to Sigiriya, home to Sri Lanka's most famous ancient sites. Settle into your jungle hotel and spend the afternoon by the pool.

3 **Sigiriya Rock and village life** SIGIRIYA

Climb Sigiriya rock fortress at dawn, passing the frescoes and lion's paws on the way to the royal summit. Later, cycle through a nearby village, take a short ride on a traditional bullock cart or catamaran, and enjoy a home-cooked lunch with a local family.

4

Polonnaruwa and elephant safari — SIGIRIYA

Explore the medieval royal city of Polonnaruwa by bicycle, with its palaces, temples and the great carved Buddhas of Gal Vihara. In the afternoon, head out on a jeep safari in Minneriya or Kaudulla to watch wild elephants gather by the water.

5

Dambulla and Kandy — KANDY

Visit the Dambulla cave temple with its ancient statues and painted ceilings, then stop at a spice garden on the way to Kandy. In the evening, attend the ceremony at the Temple of the Sacred Tooth Relic.

6

Kandy at leisure — KANDY

Stroll through the Royal Botanical Gardens at Peradeniya, famous for their orchids and avenues of giant palms. Walk around Kandy Lake and the town in the afternoon, and watch a traditional Kandyan dance performance in the evening.

7

Into tea country — NUWARA ELIYA

Climb into the hills past waterfalls and tea estates to Nuwara Eliya. Stop at a working tea factory to see how Ceylon tea is made, with a tasting overlooking the plantations.

8

Horton Plains — NUWARA ELIYA

Set off before dawn for Horton Plains National Park and walk the trail to World's End, where the land drops away nearly a kilometre to the plains below. Return to Nuwara Eliya for a relaxed afternoon by Gregory Lake.

9

Through the hills to Ella — ELLA

A beautiful drive winds down through tea estates and mountain villages to Ella, with stops at viewpoints along the way. Spend the afternoon exploring the village's cafés and enjoying the valley views.

10

Ella at leisure — ELLA

Walk up Little Adam's Peak in the cool of the morning for sweeping views of the hills. Later, visit the Nine Arches Bridge and Ravana Falls, or simply relax.

11

Down to the coast — MIRISSA

Leave the hills and drive south to Mirissa, a laid-back beach town lined with palms. Spend the afternoon on the sand.

12

Whale watching — MIRISSA

Join an early-morning boat trip with a responsible operator in search of blue whales and dolphins (optional). Spend the rest of the day on the beach or at Coconut Tree Hill.

13

Galle Fort — MIRISSA

Take a short trip along the coast to Galle Fort, a UNESCO World Heritage Site. Walk the ramparts, see the lighthouse and browse the boutiques, then return to Mirissa for a final sunset.

14

Departure — DEPARTURE

After breakfast, your chauffeur-guide drives you to the airport for your flight home.

Optional on request: Swap the day 9 drive for the scenic hill-country train to Ella, subject to seat availability.

Included

- Private air-conditioned vehicle (car, van or coach, depending on group size) with an English-speaking guide for the whole trip
- All hotels as listed (or similar), with breakfast daily; standard check-in is 12:00
- Meals and experiences named in the itinerary
- Jeep safaris and boat trips named in the itinerary

Not included

- International flights
- Visa
- Travel insurance
- Entrance fees, unless stated
- Tips

Price

- Airport meet-and-greet, all transfers, and 1 litre of bottled water per person per day
- A UK-based contact before you travel

On request, for your clients' dates and group size.

TALK TO US

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